

Small actions. *Lasting change.*

Understand the ideas. See them in everyday life. Build one small practice you can actually repeat.

Plain English · Original examples · Chapter-by-chapter orientation

20 short lessons

One idea at a time

4 practical laws

A framework for everyday action

1 personal plan

Start small. Adjust as you learn.

THE BOOK IN A MINUTE

Design the routine, then repeat the useful action.

The central approach is to improve the system around a behaviour: its cue, appeal, effort and immediate payoff. Repeated actions support your sense of who you are. Review the system as your needs change.

01 / CUE

Make it obvious

Give the action a clear signal, time or place.

02 / CRAVING

Make it attractive

Connect the action with something appealing.

03 / RESPONSE

Make it easy

Remove obstacles and shrink the starting step.

04 / REWARD

Make it satisfying

Give the action a suitable immediate payoff.

For an unwanted habit: hide its cue, reduce its appeal, add effort and make its consequences noticeable.
[Official framework ↗](#)

The “1% better” calculation is an illustration of compounding, not a promise of a particular personal result. Habit formation has no universal deadline.

THE LEARNING LIBRARY

One chapter. One clear idea.

These are concise orientations to the 20 main chapters, with our own lesson headings, examples and exercises. They do not reproduce the book’s stories or full argument. Use the source links to explore further.

CHAPTER 01 / FOUNDATIONS

Small actions accumulate

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

Repeat a useful action before chasing a dramatic result.

- Direction matters.
- Results can arrive late.
- Design a repeatable system.

IN REAL LIFE

Practise one keyboard shortcut each morning instead of redesigning your whole workflow.

TRY TODAY

Repeat one tiny improvement today.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Build evidence for your identity

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

Small actions make a new self-image more believable.

- Choose who you want to become.
- Collect small examples.
- Allow your identity to evolve.

IN REAL LIFE

Someone who wants to be considerate puts their phone away during one conversation.

TRY TODAY

Choose one action that supports your desired identity.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Understand the habit loop

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

Look for the signal, desire, action and payoff behind a repeated behaviour.

- Notice the cue.
- Name the desired feeling.
- Examine the actual reward.

IN REAL LIFE

A notification creates curiosity; opening the app briefly relieves it.

TRY TODAY

Map one routine from signal to payoff.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Notice your autopilot

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

You can change a routine more deliberately after noticing it.

- List existing routines.
- Assess which help your aims.
- Observe without self-criticism.

IN REAL LIFE

Record what happens between closing your laptop and going to bed.

TRY TODAY

Write down five routines you usually overlook.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Give your action a clear cue

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

Choose a definite moment or attach the action to an existing routine.

- Specify when and where.
- Choose a reliable anchor.
- Keep the sequence simple.

IN REAL LIFE

After watering the plant, clear one item from the desk.

TRY TODAY

Complete: After ____, I will ____.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Let your surroundings remind you

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

Place helpful cues where the action should happen.

- Make useful objects visible.
- Give activities a clear space.
- Prepare the environment in advance.

IN REAL LIFE

Put a language-practice card beside the kettle.

TRY TODAY

Move one helpful cue into view.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Remove unnecessary temptation

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

Reduce exposure to cues that trigger an unwanted routine.

- Hide distracting cues.
- Avoid repeated battles of willpower.
- Keep helpful alternatives nearby.

IN REAL LIFE

Place the game controller in a drawer before a study session.

TRY TODAY

Remove one cue before the next difficult moment.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Make the routine appealing

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

Connect a useful action with something you enjoy.

- Anticipation can motivate.
- Pair a useful and enjoyable activity.
- Keep the pairing compatible.

IN REAL LIFE

Listen to a favourite instrumental playlist while sorting paperwork.

TRY TODAY

Choose a pleasure that fits your useful action.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Choose a supportive social setting

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

People around you help define what feels normal.

- Notice what your group encourages.
- Join people with compatible routines.
- Make belonging support your goal.

IN REAL LIFE

Join a weekly sketching circle where practising is normal.

TRY TODAY

Find one group that already practises your chosen behaviour.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Find the need behind the habit

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

An unwanted action may be an attempt to meet a real need.

- Identify the feeling you seek.
- Reconsider the habit's appeal.
- Try a better response to that need.

IN REAL LIFE

If shopping follows loneliness, test calling a friend before browsing.

TRY TODAY

Name the need and one alternative response.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Practise instead of only preparing

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

Repetition builds familiarity; endless planning can delay action.

- Preparation is useful but limited.
- Perform the real behaviour.
- Count meaningful attempts.

IN REAL LIFE

Record a short spoken sentence rather than collecting more speaking tips.

TRY TODAY

Do one small real attempt now.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Remove steps from the good habit

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

An action is easier to repeat when fewer obstacles stand in its way.

- Reduce setup effort.
- Prepare the next session.
- Add friction to unwanted actions.

IN REAL LIFE

Leave drawing tools arranged on a tray after practice.

TRY TODAY

Remove one setup step.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Start with a two-minute version

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

Make the beginning so small that showing up feels manageable.

- Shrink the entry action.
- Establish it before expanding.
- Let it lead to a larger routine.

IN REAL LIFE

Open the language app and practise one sound.

TRY TODAY

Write the smallest honest version of your habit.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Prepare your future choice

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

Make a useful decision in advance so you need fewer later decisions.

- Use supportive defaults.
- Commit before temptation arrives.
- Review automated choices periodically.

IN REAL LIFE

Set an app timer before the evening starts.

TRY TODAY

Set one reversible commitment for tomorrow.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Give progress an immediate payoff

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

A small positive finish can help a useful action feel worth repeating.

- Long-term benefits may be delayed.
- Add a suitable immediate reward.
- Avoid rewards that undo the purpose.

IN REAL LIFE

After tidying one shelf, pause to enjoy the clear space.

TRY TODAY

Choose a small satisfying finish.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Make consistency visible

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

A simple record helps you notice repetition and recover after a lapse.

- Track the action honestly.
- Restart after a missed opportunity.
- Check quality as well as counts.

IN REAL LIFE

Mark each completed pronunciation practice; note one sound that improved.

TRY TODAY

Record today's action, then plan the next chance.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Use supportive accountability

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

A clear agreement with another person can make follow-through more noticeable.

- Specify the behaviour.
- Arrange a check-in.
- Use proportionate consequences.

IN REAL LIFE

Tell a study partner which session you will complete and when you will report back.

TRY TODAY

Write one precise check-in agreement.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Choose a practice that fits you

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

Your strengths and preferences can help you choose a promising field of effort.

- Explore before committing.
- Notice where you improve readily.
- Fit is useful; effort still matters.

IN REAL LIFE

Test sketching, audio editing and writing; compare energy and progress.

TRY TODAY

Try two approaches and compare your response.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Keep the challenge manageable

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

A task just beyond your current ability can keep practice engaging.

- Avoid boredom and overload.
- Increase difficulty gradually.
- Continue through ordinary sessions.

IN REAL LIFE

Practise a slightly harder rhythm after a basic one becomes easy.

TRY TODAY

Make one small adjustment to difficulty.

[Read the source ↗](#)

Review the routine to keep improving

[Open the 15-second video ↗](#)

Automatic repetition can hide mistakes; reflection and focused practice help you improve.

- Inspect your results periodically.
- Practise the weak component.
- Keep your self-image flexible.

IN REAL LIFE

Review a recording, identify one unclear sound, and practise it deliberately.

TRY TODAY

Choose one routine to review this week.

[Read the source ↗](#)

My seven-day experiment

One small behaviour. A reliable cue. A useful review.

Who I want to become:

After this existing routine:

I will do this two-minute action:

I will make it easy by:

My immediate, suitable payoff:

If I miss an opportunity, I will:

Record completed actions:

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5	Day 6	Day 7
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At the end of the week: What helped? What should I simplify?

GO DEEPER

Read the author. Use the official tools.

Free resources provided by James Clear, plus access to the original book. This companion is independently produced and is not affiliated with or endorsed by the author or publisher.

The original book and authorised editions ↗

[Official habit cheat sheet \(PDF\) ↗](#)

[Official habit loop \(PDF\) ↗](#)

[Official habit scorecard \(PDF\) ↗](#)

[Official habit tracker \(PDF\) ↗](#)

[Chapter references and research notes ↗](#)

[Our sources and interpretation notes ↗](#)

[Original video scripts ↗](#)

[Author's free habit cheat sheet \(PDF\) ↗](#)

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Atomic Habits is by James Clear. Examples and exercises here are original. Twenty original short demonstrations turn each chapter theme into a concrete action.